tradition existed and circumstances allowed sufficient wealth to be gained.

Finally, there are those few who, after 50 years of leftist experimentation, still believe or hope for a genuine Social Democracy. Such a strong and genuine Social Democratic tradition exists in the Czech Republic, for example, despite their recent electoral setback.

The political landscape in the new democracies of Eastern Europe continues to change – something that we can also observe in the West. The transition from a Communist totalitarian system to a capitalist democracy was from many aspects a success, judged by macro-economic figures and the fact that the countries of Eastern Europe joined the EU and NATO. But this success also in many ways outpaced society's and many individuals' capacity to adapt to the changes. While some disproportionally benefitted from it, sometimes owing to undue comparative advantages rooted in the totalitarian past, others were left behind, often confused and frustrated. This created an array of competing new social identities, not always to be pinpointed easily. In this atmosphere, the fall of Communism began to be seen as a distant event, with less and less bearing on the present. There were other things to be worried about, many people in former Communist countries began to think and feel – and they were probably right. As if this was not enough, on top came the worsening geopolitical situation in Europe and the world, combined with economic, migration and health crises. Thus thirty years after the fall of the Berlin Wall a stage was set for what would come to be known as 'illiberal Europe', with its geographic centre seen as located in Eastern Europe. Eastern Europe was finally placed at the centre of (unwanted) attention.

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88. Bohle, D, Greskovits, B, *Capitalist Diversity on Europe's Periphery*, Cornell University Press, Ithaca and London 2012, pp. 260 – 265.

89. Ibid.

90. Ibid.

91. Maria Todorova in *Imagining the Balkans*, Oxford University Press 1997, notes that the term was not coined in the context of the Balkan nations' struggle for independence from the Ottoman Empire, but when the Austro-Hungarian and Russian Empires fell apart and this resembled the disintegration of the Ottoman Empire. (See pp. 32–35.)

92. Pope John Paul II, *Memory and Identity*, Orion, 2005.

93. Taylor, C, *A Secular Age*, Cambridge, Massachusetts: Belknap Press of Harvard University Press, 2007.

94. Riemen, R, *To Fight Against This Age: On Fascism and Humanism*, W. W. Norton & Company, 2018, p. 32.